FREE GUIDE · UPDATED NOVEMBER 2026

A faster computer, for free, in one afternoon

Before thinking about a new computer, try these steps: they are often enough.

1. Fewer programs at start-up

- **Windows**: open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) › Startup apps and disable what you don't need as soon as it starts. Leave the antivirus on.
- **Mac**: System Settings › General › Login Items.

2. Free disk space

Leave at least 15–20% of the disk free. On Windows: Settings › System › Storage › Cleanup recommendations. Empty the Downloads folder and the recycle bin, and uninstall programs you don't use.

3. A light browser

Few open tabs, remove extensions you don't use. One browser is enough.

4. Updates and a check

Update the system and drivers and run a scan with Microsoft Defender, already included in Windows.

Beware of "PC speed-up programs" advertised online: they often slow the computer down, or are scams.

5. Dust and heat

Dust in the fans makes the computer overheat, and it slows down to protect itself. With the computer off and unplugged, blow compressed air in short bursts while holding the fan still.

If a laptop battery is swollen, stop using it and have it replaced: it's dangerous.

When it's not enough

- **Mechanical disk**: replacing it with an SSD is the change you'll feel most.
- **4 GB of memory or less**: if possible, adding RAM costs little.
- **System too heavy**: a light Linux brings even ten- or fifteen-year-old computers back to life.

Want to know what's worth doing with your computer? Take the one-minute test on the website: I'll tell you the path and the cost.

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